

TERROR

‘Thousands’ dead as hijacked jets slam Trade Center, Pentagon



Kelly Guenther/New York Times

A second aircraft approaches the Tower Two of the World Trade Center just before hitting the skyscraper while Tower One burns Tuesday.

Trapped survivors call for help on cellphones

Republic news services

In the worst terrorist attack in U.S. history, knife-wielding hijackers struck Tuesday at the symbols of American financial and military might, using jetliners as suicide missiles to level the twin towers of the World Trade Center in New York City and blast into the Pentagon.

As fires still smoldered less than a mile away from the White House, a grim President Bush told the nation that “thousands” had died in the attacks and promised to hunt down those responsible for them. “We will make no distinction,” he said, “between the terrorists who committed these acts and those who harbor them.”

Bush, who was in Florida at an education event at the time of the catastrophe, was shuttled to an Air Force Base in Louisiana, then to a Strategic Air Command bunker in Nebraska for security reasons before returning to Washington.

Early today, unstable debris prevented crews from going into ground zero of the terrorist attack in New York to search for survivors and recover bodies. One man caught under the rubble used his cellphone to reach family in Pennsylvania with a plea for help.

Establishing the death toll in the most dramatic attack on American soil since Pearl Harbor could take weeks. The four airliners alone had 266 people aboard, and there were no known survivors.

A New York City firefighters union official estimated 300 firefighters may have died. Another fire official said dozens were missing.

“The number of casualties will be more than most of us can bear,” a visibly distraught Mayor Rudolph Giuliani said.

At the Pentagon, officials put the number of dead and wounded at 100 or more, with some news reports suggesting



Suzanne Plunkett/Associated Press

People run from the collapse of the World Trade Center on Tuesday in New York. Establishing the death toll in the most dramatic attack on American soil since Pearl Harbor could take weeks. “The number of casualties will be more than most of us can bear,” a visibly distraught Mayor Rudolph Giuliani said.

IN NEW YORK: Chaos reigns, and things will never be the same in the world's financial nerve center. **EX3, 5.**

IN WASHINGTON, D.C.: After terror hits the Pentagon, America's government gets back on its feet and plans what to do next. **EX6-7.**

IN THE VALLEY: From residents stunned by horrific TV images to travelers stuck at the airport, tragedy touches the Phoenix area. **EX16-17.**

HOW TO COPE: Valley residents look for ways to help, explain tragedy to kids. **EX18.**

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